# Introduction to Management MGNT110

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# Gibbs Reflective Cycle (1988)

Tutorial 1

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# What is Reflection?

- Students often confuse reflection with summary. Reflection must include analysis and learning.
- **Reflection = Thinking about experience to learn**
- Not just describing what happened
- Understanding meaning
- Improving future actions

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# Why is Reflection Important?

- Helps improve performance
- Develops critical thinking
- Builds self-awareness
- Encourages continuous learning

- **In Management:**
  - Better decision-making
  - Better leadership

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# Graham Gibbs

- Developed Reflective Cycle in 1988
- Focus: learning through experience
- Widely used in:
  - Education
  - Healthcare
  - Business

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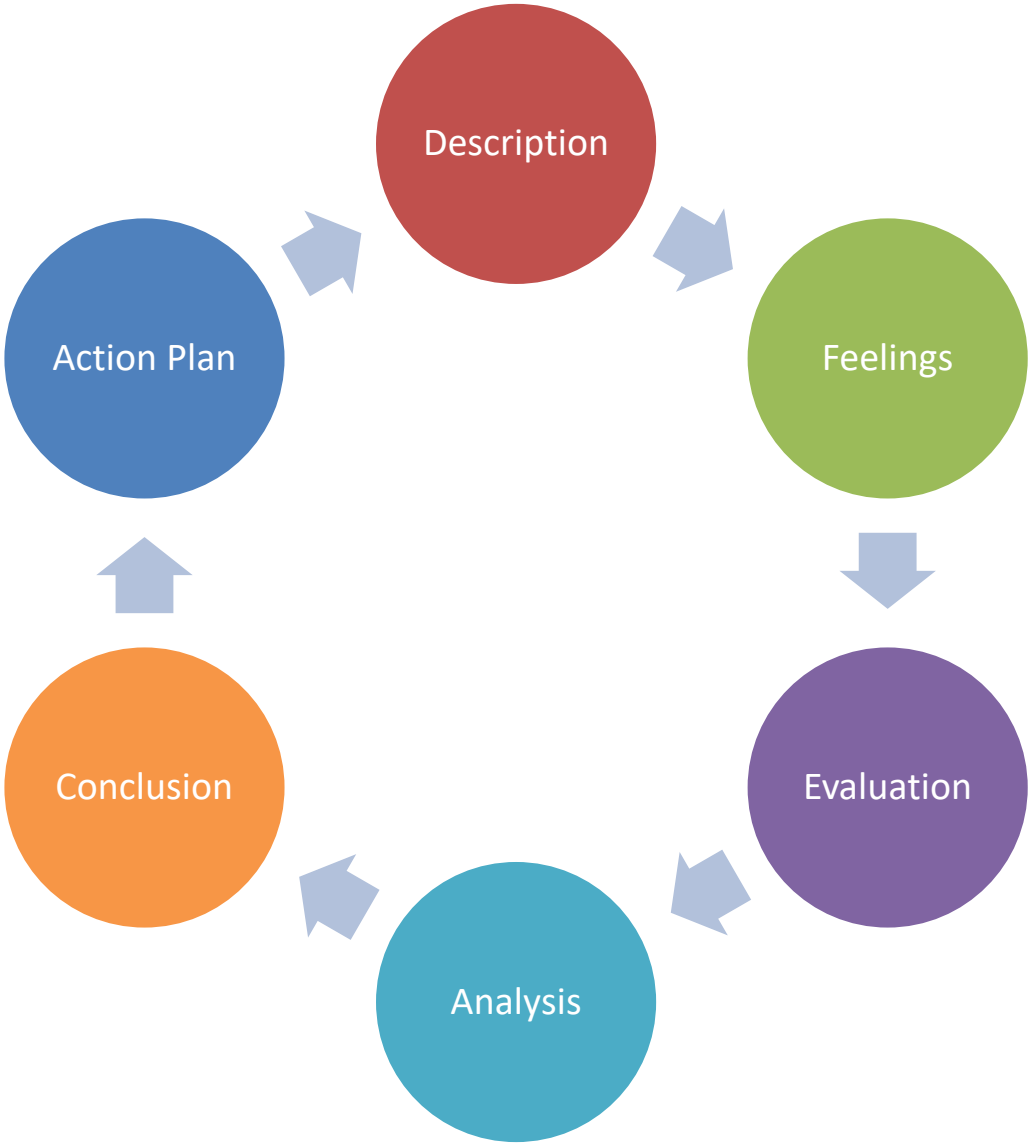
# The 6 Stages of Gibbs' Cycle




Reflection is a cycle (continuous improvement)

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# Stage 1 – Description

- **What happened?**
  - Facts only
  - No judgement
  - Set the context

- **Guide Questions:**
  - What happened?
  - Who was involved?
  - What did you do?

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# Stage 1 – Description

- **What happened?**
  - Facts only
  - No judgement
  - Set the context
- **Guide Questions:**
  - What happened?
  - Who was involved?
  - What did you do?

**Example (Description):**
"I led a class discussion, but only a few students participated."

- Simple, factual
- No analysis yet

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# Stage 2 – Feelings

- **What were you thinking & feeling?**
  - Before
  - During
  - After

- **Examples:**
  - Nervous
  - Confident
  - Frustrated

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# Stage 2 – Feelings

- **What were you thinking & feeling?**
  - Before
  - During
  - After

- **Examples:**
  - Nervous
  - Confident
  - Frustrated

**Example (Feelings)**
"I felt confident at first, but became anxious when students were quiet."

- Shows self-awareness
- Important for reflection depth

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# Stage 3 – Evaluation

- **What was good & bad?**
  - Positive aspects
  - Negative aspects

- **Questions:**
  - What worked well?
  - What didn't?

# Stage 3 – Evaluation

- **What was good & bad?**
  - Positive aspects
  - Negative aspects
- **Questions:**
  - What worked well?
  - What didn't?

**Example (Evaluation)**
"Some students gave good answers, but most were passive."

- Identify **BOTH** strengths & weaknesses

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# Stage 4 – Analysis (MOST IMPORTANT)

- **Why did it happen?**
  - Explain reasons
  - Use theory
  - Go deeper

- **Questions:**
  - Why did this happen?
  - What influenced it?
  - What theory explains it?

- Students often confuse reflection with summary.
- Reflection must include analysis and learning.

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# Stage 4 – Analysis (MOST IMPORTANT)

- **Why did it happen?**
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  - Use theory
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- **Questions:**
  - Why did this happen?
  - What influenced it?
  - What theory explains it?

**Example (Analysis)**
"Students may not have felt comfortable speaking. My questions may have been too broad….
This may be attributed to….
According to Hegel (1977), the Dialectical Perspective……."

- Link to theories
- Show critical thinking

- Students often confuse reflection with summary.
- Reflection must include analysis and learning.

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# Stage 5 – Conclusion

- **What have you learned?**
  - Key takeaway
  - What could be improved

- **Questions:**
  - What did I learn?
  - What would I change?

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# Stage 5 – Conclusion

- **What have you learned?**
  - Key takeaway
  - What could be improved

- **Questions:**
  - What did I learn?
  - What would I change?

**Example (Conclusion)**
"I learned that preparation alone is not enough. I need to improve student engagement. I would…."

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# Stage 6 – Action Plan

- **What will you do next time?**
  - Specific actions
  - Practical improvement

- **Examples:**
  - Use group discussion
  - Ask clearer questions
  - Practise delivery

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# Stage 6 – Action Plan

- **What will you do next time?**
  - Specific actions
  - Practical improvement
- **Examples:**
  - Use group discussion
  - Ask clearer questions
  - Practise delivery

**Example (Action Plan)**
"I will use small group discussions before class sharing to increase participation."

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# Common Mistakes

- Too much description
- No analysis
- No action plan
- No theory

# Good Reflection vs Weak Reflection

| Weak: | Strong: |
| --- | --- |
| "I did this. Then this happened." | "This happened because…<br>I learned that…<br>Next time I will…" |

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# Sentence Starters

- **Description:**
  - One situation I experienced was…
- **Analysis:**
  - This happened because…
- **Action Plan:**
  - Next time, I will…

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# When to Use Gibbs?

- Presentations
- Group work
- Internships
- Workplace situations
- Leadership experiences

**Reflection = Learn → Improve → Apply**

- Think deeper
- Not just describe
- Always end with ACTION

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# Recommended word count for your assignment II

| Stage(s) | Word |
|---|---|
| 1. Description (Introduction) | 200 |
| 2. Feelings | 200 |
| 3. Evaluation | 350 |
| 4. Analysis | 350 |
| 5. Conclusion | 200 |
| 6. Action | 200 |
| TOTAL | 1500 |

- Don't forget your referencing!
- (intext citations + Ref list)
- Cite your textbook and 3-6 journals

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- Gibbs, G. (1988). *Learning by Doing: A Guide to Teaching and Learning Methods.*

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